Technical Specification: HRMS to NovaShield SAML 2.0 SSO & Census Sync API

1. SAML 2.0 Single Sign-On Flow

Employees authenticate via corporate Google Workspace IdP. SAML assertions pass `user_id`, `grade_tier`, and `dept_id` to NovaShield's benefit portal endpoint (`https://sso.novashieldhealth.com/saml2/acs`).

2. Deployment Timeline & Current Blocker

Scheduled production deployment of the SAML 2.0 SSO enrollment widget is pushed to October 23, 2026 at 16:00 IST because NovaShield's sandbox OAuth2 refresh token throws an `ERR_TOKEN_TTL_MISMATCH` after 300 seconds. Until October 23, employees cannot use self-service SSO on the vendor's external portal.